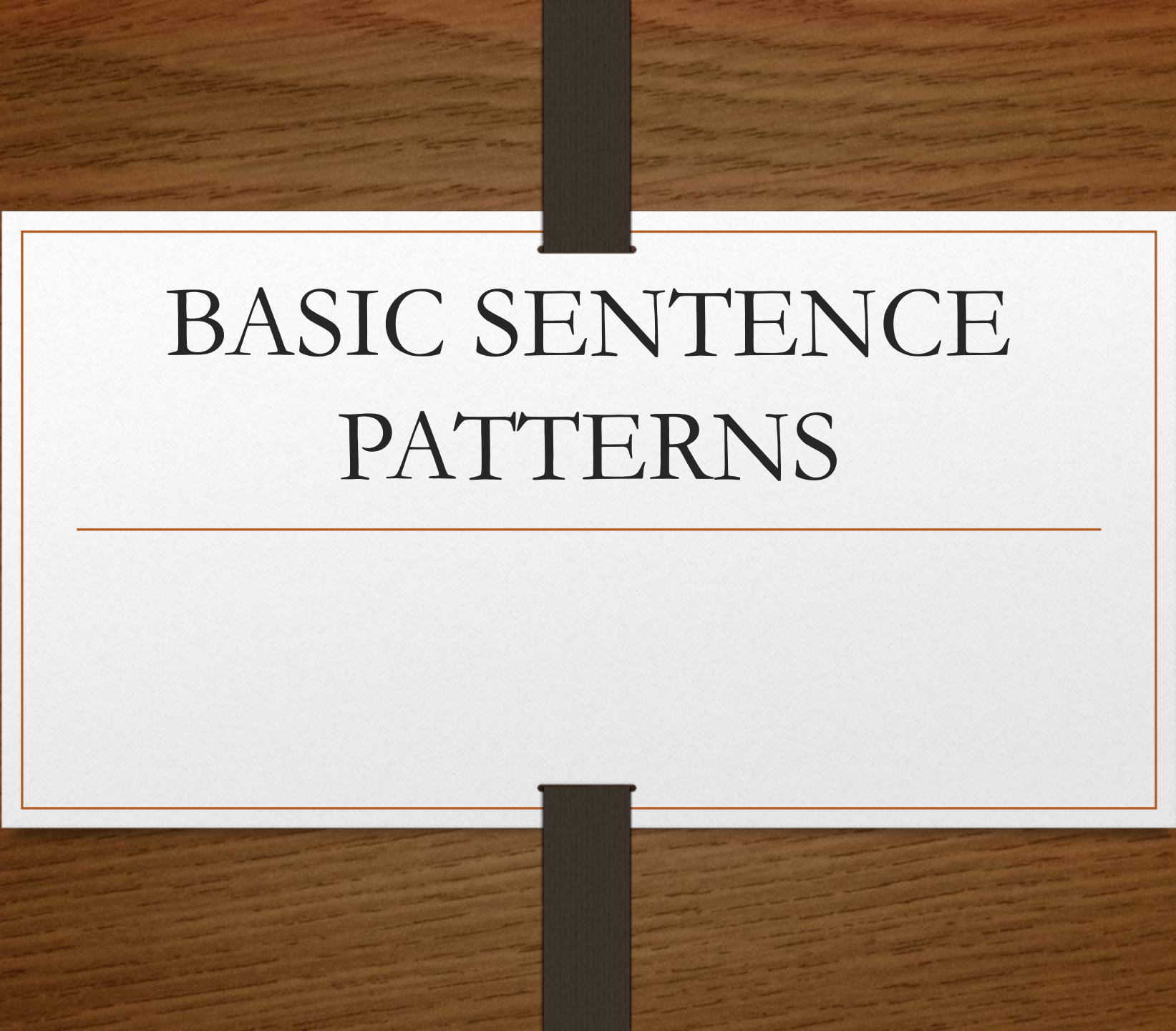




BASIC SENTENCE PATTERNS

Subject + verb. The simplest of sentence patterns is composed of a **subject** and **verb** without a direct object or subject complement.

It uses an **intransitive verb**, that is, a verb requiring no direct object:

The **cross-member** exposed to abnormal stress eventually **broke**.

Only two **types** of charge **exist** in nature.

Subject + linking verb + subject complement. Another simple pattern uses the **linking verb**, any form of the to be verb without an action verb:

The chain **reaction is** the basis of nuclear power.

The **debate** over nuclear power **has** often **been** bitter.

Folding and **faulting** of the earth's surface **are** important geologic processes.

Subject + verb + direct object. Another common sentence pattern uses the **direct object**:

Silicon conducts **electricity** in an unusual way.

The anti-reflective coating on the the silicon cell reduces **reflection** from 32 to 22 percent.

Prestressing of the concrete increases the load-carrying **capacity** of the members.

Subject + verb + indirect object + direct object. The sentence pattern with the **indirect object** and **direct object** is similar to the preceding pattern:

We are sending **you** the **balance** of the payment in this letter.

I am writing **her** about a number of problems that I have had with my Execucomp wordprocessor.

The supervisor mailed the **applicant** a **description** of the job.

Subject + verb + direct object + object complement. The sentence pattern using the [direct object] and object complement is not common but worth knowing:

The plant shutdown left the entire **area** an economic **disaster**.

The committee declared the new **design** a **breakthrough** in energy efficiency.